

4. Reduce annoying pop-ups.

Internet Explorer Pop-Up Blocker makes browsing the Internet more enjoyable by helping you reduce the unwanted ads and content that pop up when you're browsing the Web.

5. Get firewall protection from startup to shutdown.

The inbuilt Windows Firewall is, in SP2, turned on by default. This helps protect XP against viruses and worms.

6. Take control of your security settings.

The new Windows Security Center allows you to easily view your security status and manage key security settings in one convenient place.

7. Get the latest updates easily.

Enhancements to XP's Automatic Updates feature make it even easier to access Windows updates. Plus, new technology has been added to help dial-up customers download updates more efficiently.

8. Help protect your e-mail address.

Improvements to Outlook Express help reduce unwanted e-mail by limiting the possibility of your e-mail address being validated by potential spammers.

9. Take action against crashes caused by browser add-ons.

The new Add-On Manager in Internet Explorer lets you easily view and control add-ons to reduce the potential for crashes and enjoy a more trouble-free browsing experience.

10. Hassle-free wireless.

SP2 improves wireless support and simplifies the process of discovering and connecting to wireless networks.

9.9.2 Service Packs 1 and 1a

You don't need to bother about these, since installing SP2 installs whatever came with SP1 and SP1a. Note, however, that SP1 came with the JVM (Java Virtual Machine), whereas SP1a did not. In keep-